

Session 2 — Twelve Years

632–644 · everything below is page-cited · you will use maybe a third of it

Why this document exists. The script tells you what to say. This tells you what you *know* — so that when a question comes, or you have four minutes spare, or someone challenges a detail, you are standing on something. Read it once. Do not try to deliver it.

Sources: al-Bidāya wa'l-Nihāya (Ibn Kathīr, ed. Dār Ibn Kathīr) and Siyar A' lām al-Nubalā' (al-Dhahabī, ed. al-Risāla) — both named and recommended in the muqaddima of our own source. Volume and page given for everything.

1. The succession — what actually happened at Saqīfa

The core account is the famous one narrated by Ibn 'Abbās[ؓ] from 'Abd al-Raḥmān ibn 'Awf[ؓ], recorded by Imām Aḥmad — it is 'Umar[ؓ] himself describing the day, years later, from the minbar in Madina.

'Umar[ؓ] waited to say it in the right place

He first intended to address the matter at Minā during Ḥajj. 'Abd al-Raḥmān ibn 'Awf[ؓ] talked him out of it: the Ḥajj season gathers رَعَاعَ النَّاسِ وَغَوَّاءَهُمْ — the rabble and the crowd — who would carry the words away and put them in the wrong places. Wait for Madina, he said, فَإِنَّهَا دَارُ الْهِجْرَةِ وَالسَّنَةِ, and speak to the people of knowledge who will place your words correctly.

Worth using. This is a Companion[ؓ] being counselled on *where* to say a difficult thing — and taking the advice. It sets exactly the tone you want for a course that handles disputed material carefully. Two sentences, no more.

al-Bidāya, vol. 5 p. 344

The room, on the day

- The Anṣār had gathered in the saqīfa of Banū Sā'ida. 'Alī[ؓ], al-Zubayr[ؓ] and those with them were at Fāṭima's[ؓ] house. The Muhājirūn gathered to Abū Bakr[ؓ].
- 'Umar[ؓ]: “Abū Bakr, let us go to our brothers among the Anṣār.” On the way two righteous men — 'Uwaym ibn Sā'ida and Ma'n ibn 'Adī — met them and told them what was happening.
- The Anṣār's proposal: مِّنَّا أَمِيرٌ وَمِنْكُمْ أَمِيرٌ — a leader from us and a leader from you.

al-Bidāya, vol. 5 pp. 345–346

'Umar[ؓ] had prepared a speech — and did not give it

He had composed something in his head. Abū Bakrؓ spoke first, and ‘Umarؓ says: he was **أَحْلَمَ مِنِّي وَأَوْقَرَ** — more forbearing and more dignified than I — and he did not leave out a single phrase I had liked in my own draft, and said it better, until I fell silent.

This is a gift for a nervous speaker. The strongest man in the room had prepared, deferred, and was glad of it. If you want one human moment in the Saqīfa block, this is it.

al-Bidāya, vol. 5 p. 346

Abū Bakr’sؓ argument, and what he did next

مَا ذَكَّرْتُمْ مِنْ خَيْرٍ فَأَنْتُمْ أَهْلُهُ... وَقَدْ رَضِيتُ لَكُمْ أَحَدَ هَذَيْنِ الرَّجُلَيْنِ، أَيُّمَا شِئْتُمْ

“Whatever good you have mentioned of yourselves, you are worthy of it... and I am content for you with one of these two men — whichever you wish.”

And he took hold of ‘Umar’sؓ hand and Abū ‘Ubayda’sؓ hand.

al-Bidāya, vol. 5 p. 346

‘Umarؓ on that moment — and this is the line to know:

وَاللَّهِ لَأَنْ أُقَدِّمَ فَتُضْرَبَ عُنُقِي... أَحَبُّ إِلَيَّ مِنْ أَنْ أَتَأَمَّرَ عَلَى قَوْمٍ فِيهِمْ أَبُو بَكْرٍ

“By God, that I be brought forward and my neck struck would be dearer to me than that I should command a people among whom is Abū Bakr.”

al-Bidāya, vol. 5 p. 346

Then the noise rose — فَكَثُرَ اللَّغَطُ وَارْتَفَعَتِ الْأَصْوَاتُ حَتَّى خَشِينَا الْإِخْتِلَافَ — and ‘Umarؓ said: **“Stretch out your hand, Abū Bakr.”**

Note for accuracy: Ibn Sa‘d records that the first to actually strike the pledge was **Bashīr ibn Sa‘dؓ** — father of al-Nu‘mān ibn Bashīr — who got there before ‘Umarؓ.

al-Bidāya, vol. 5 pp. 346–347

2. The argument that actually settled it

Not lineage, not seniority — **the prayer**. ‘Umar[ؓ] turned to the Anṣār and asked:

أَلَسْتُمْ تَعْلَمُونَ أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَدْ أَمَرَ أَبَا بَكْرٍ أَنْ يُؤَمَّ النَّاسَ؟
فَأَيُّكُمْ تَطِيبُ نَفْسُهُ أَنْ يَتَقَدَّمَ أَبَا بَكْرٍ؟

“Do you not know that the Messenger of God ﷺ ordered Abū Bakr to lead the people in prayer? Which of you would be content to step in front of Abū Bakr?”

The Anṣār answered: نَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ أَنْ نَتَقَدَّمَ أَبَا بَكْرٍ — “We seek refuge in God from stepping ahead of Abū Bakr.”

al-Bidāya, vol. 5 p. 347 · narrated by al-Nasā’ī, isnād ḥasan

If you say only one thing about Saqīfa, say this. It is short, it is sound, it settles the question on a ground no one in your room will dispute, and it requires you to evaluate nobody.

Sa’d ibn ‘Ubāda[ؓ] concedes

Abū Bakr[ؓ] reminded them of what the Prophet ﷺ had said of the Anṣār — including لَوْ سَلَكَ النَّاسُ وَادِيًا — and Sa’d[ؓ] replied:

صَدَقْتَ، نَحْنُ الْوُزَرَاءُ وَأَنْتُمْ الْأُمَرَاءُ

“You have spoken truly. We are the ministers and you are the commanders.”

al-Bidāya, vol. 5 p. 348 · Imām Aḥmad

Why Abū Bakr[ؓ] accepted at all — in his own words

فَبَايَعُونِي لِذَلِكَ وَقَبِلْتُهَا مِنْهُمْ، وَتَخَوَّفْتُ أَنْ تَكُونَ فِتْنَةً بَعْدَهَا رَدَّةٌ

“So they pledged to me on that basis and I accepted it from them — and I feared there would be a fitna, and after it apostasy.”

al-Bidāya, vol. 5 p. 348 · Imām Aḥmad, from Rāfi‘ al-Ṭā’ī · Ibn Kathīr: إِسْنَادٌ جَيِّدٌ قَوِيٌّ

Ibn Kathīr’s own comment: he accepted the imāma only out of fear of a fitna greater than his refusing it would have been.

This is the frame for the whole evening. He did not want it. He took it because the alternative was worse — and within weeks he was proved exactly right. The Ridda began.

The timing, precisely

The saqīfa pledge was on the **Monday**. The general pledge of all the Muhājirūn and Anṣār was completed in the masjid on the **Tuesday morning**, before the Prophet ﷺ was buried.

al-Bidāya, vol. 5 p. 348

The one thing you will be asked about, so know it before you stand up.

In the same sermon ‘Umar رضي الله عنه says the pledge to Abū Bakr رضي الله عنه was **فَلْتَةً** — “sudden / unarranged”. Somebody in a Tanzeem-e-Islami room may well know this and raise it.

What it means: **فَلْتَةً** means it happened *without prior arrangement or consultation of the whole community* — not that it was a mistake. ‘Umar رضي الله عنه says so himself in the very next breath: **أَلَا وَإِنَّ اللَّهَ وَقَى شَرَّهَا، وَلَيْسَ فِيكُمْ** **الْيَوْمَ مَنْ تَقَطَّعَ إِلَيْهِ الْأَعْنَاقُ مِثْلَ أَبِي بَكْرٍ** — “God protected from its evil, and there is none among you today to whom necks are stretched as they were to Abū Bakr.” His point in that sermon is a *warning against repeating it* — that no future pledge should be made without consultation.

How to answer: say what ‘Umar رضي الله عنه said, both halves, and stop. Do not extend it.

al-Bidāya, vol. 5 p. 345

3. The Ridda — the part the script only gestures at

They attacked Madina within days

After the delegations were refused, they moved fast: **within three days** they raided Madina, leaving half their force at Dhū Ḥusā as a reserve. The guards sent word to Abū Bakr[ؓ]; he sent back the order **الزُّمُوا مَكَانَكُمْ** — hold your positions — and then went out himself, with the people of the masjid, mounted on **water-carrying camels** (النواضح), because that is what they had. The enemy broke and the Muslims pursued them to Dhū Ḥusā.

al-Bidāya, vol. 7 p. 20

The trick with the waterskins

In Jumādā al-Ākhira, Abū Bakr[ؓ] rode out against Banū ‘Abs, Banū Murra and Dhubyān. They had prepared a stratagem: they inflated **waterskins** and rolled them down the hillsides. The Muslims’ camels bolted and could not be brought under control until nightfall — they ran all the way back to Madina.

The tribes took this for weakness and killed the Muslims among them. Abū Bakr[ؓ] swore he would kill from every tribe as many as they had killed, and more.

al-Bidāya, vol. 7 pp. 20–21

Use this if the evening feels too clean. It is a reverse, and it is in the sources. History told without setbacks is not believable, and the room will trust you more for it.

Three caravans in one night

Then the turn. Ibn Kathīr: this engagement “was among the greatest helps to the victory of Islam and its people” — the Muslims became strong in every tribe and the disbelievers humbled. And on one night, **three zakāt caravans reached Madina** — one at the beginning of the night, one in the middle, one at the end:

CARAVAN	ANNOUNCED BY
Ṣafwān’s	Sa’d ibn Abī Waqqāṣ [ؓ]
al-Zibriqān’s	‘Abd al-Raḥmān ibn ‘Awf [ؓ]
‘Adī ibn Ḥātim’s	‘Abd Allāh ibn Mas‘ūd [ؓ] — or Abū Qatāda al-Anṣārī [ؓ]

All of this **sixty nights** after the Prophet ﷺ passed away.

al-Bidāya, vol. 7 p. 21

This closes the loop on your opening scene. You open with those same men standing guard on the passes at night. Now they are the ones running in with the news. Same men, same nights, and the zakāt is arriving after all — which is the whole argument, arriving as fact.

‘Alī[ؓ] takes hold of his mount

Abū Bakrؓ rode out to Dhū al-Qaṣṣa with his sword drawn, and ‘Alīؓ took the reins of his camel:

إِلَى أَيْنَ يَا خَلِيفَةَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ؟ أَقُولُ لَكَ مَا قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَوْمَ أُحُدٍ:
لَمْ سَيْفَكَ وَلَا تَفْجَعْنَا بِنَفْسِكَ

“Where to, O Caliph of the Messenger of God? I say to you what the Messenger of God ﷺ said on the day of Uḥud: sheathe your sword, and do not afflict us with the loss of yourself.”

al-Bidāya, vol. 7 p. 22 · al-Dāraqūṭnī; also from ‘Ā’ishaؓ

Abū Bakr’sؓ answer, when the Companionsؓ pressed him to send someone else and stay behind: وَاللَّهِ لَا أَفْعَلُ، وَلَا أُوَسِّدُكُمْ بِنَفْسِي — “By God I will not. I will share it with you in person.”

al-Bidāya, vol. 7 p. 21

Note carefully: ‘Alīؓ is *leading the caliph’s mount* and pleading with him not to risk himself. If anyone in your room carries an assumption about relations between these two, this scene answers it — and you have not had to argue anything. State it and move on.

4. The eleven banners

The script says “the columns go out” and deliberately gives no number, because the number had not been verified. It is **eleven**. Ibn Kathīr’s chapter heading is literally **خُرُوجُهُ إِلَى ذِي الْقَصَّةِ حِينَ عَقَدَ الْوَيْةَ الْأَمْرَاءُ الْأَحَدَ عَشَرَ**.

COMMANDER	SENT AGAINST / TO
Khālīd ibn al-Walīd [ؓ] — “chief of the commanders”	Ṭulayḥa al-Asadī at Buzākha, then onward
al-Muhājir ibn Abī Umayya [ؓ]	the forces of al-‘Anṣī; and the Abnā’ against Qays ibn Makshūḥ
Khālīd ibn Sa‘īd ibn al-‘Āṣ [ؓ]	the marches of Shām
‘Amr ibn al-‘Āṣ [ؓ]	the gathering of Quḍā‘a, Wadī‘a and al-Ḥārith
Ḥudhayfa ibn Miḥṣan al-Ghaṭafānī [ؓ]	the people of Dabā
‘Arfaja [ؓ] · Ḥarthama [ؓ]	with the above
Ṭarafa ibn Ḥājib [ؓ]	Banū Sulaym and those with them of Hawāzin
Suwayd ibn Muqarrin [ؓ]	Tihāma of Yemen
al-‘Alā’ ibn al-Ḥaḍramī [ؓ]	Bahrain

Each commander was given his own written commission, and each moved out from Dhū al-Qaṣṣa.

al-Bidāya, vol. 7 p. 23

The letter — and the sign of the adhān

Abū Bakr[ؓ] sent a written letter ahead to the apostates. It opens **مِنْ أَبِي بَكْرٍ خَلِيفَةِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ** and quotes al-Zumar 39:30, al-Anbiyā’ 21:34, al-Kahf 18:50 and Fāṭir 35:6. The instruction to the commanders inside it is the striking part:

وَالدَّاعِيَةُ الْأَذَانُ، فَإِذَا أَدَّنَ الْمُسْلِمُونَ فَأَذِنُوا فَكُفُّوا عَنْهُمْ

“And the sign is the adhān: when the Muslims call the adhān, if they call it back — hold off from them.”

al-Bidāya, vol. 7 p. 24

He also ordered that no commander fight anyone until he had first called them to God, and that whoever answered and affirmed and acted rightly was to be accepted and helped.

Use this against the caricature. The commanders were instructed to call first, and to stop at the sound of an adhān. That is a specific, sourced instruction and it does more work than any amount of general assurance.

Khālīd ibn al-Walīd[ؓ] — what the Prophet ﷺ said of him

When Abū Bakrؓ appointed him over the fighting of the apostates, Waḥshī ibn Ḥarb reported the Prophet ﷺ having said: خَالِدُ بْنُ الْوَلِيدِ، أَخُو الْعَشِيرَةِ، — “an excellent servant of God and brother of the clan, Khālīd ibn al-Walīd.”

al-Bidāya, vol. 7 p. 24 · Imām Aḥmad

5. Two men who came back — the point of the whole campaign

‘Uyayna ibn Ḥiṣn had apostatised, saying to his people: “By God, a prophet from Banū Asad is dearer to me than a prophet from Banū Hāshim.” Captured by Khālīdؓ, he was sent to Madina with his hands bound to his neck; children poked at him in the street calling him an enemy of God, and he answered, “By God, I never believed at all.” Brought before Abū Bakrؓ, **he was asked to repent, and his blood was spared** — and his Islam was good afterwards.

Ṭulayḥa al-Asadī — the false prophet himself — returned to Islam, went to Makka for ‘umra during Abū Bakr’sؓ caliphate, and was too ashamed to face him for the rest of his life. He later fought *alongside* Khālīdؓ.

al-Bidāya, vol. 7 p. 26

This is the answer to “so it was just slaughter”. The two most prominent leaders of the rebellion both ended as Muslims, one of them fighting on the same side. The campaign was about restoring an order, not about revenge — and the sources say so plainly.

‘Adī ibn Ḥātīmؓ, who saved his own tribe twice

He asked Khālīdؓ for three days’ grace for Ṭayy, because those who had gone over to Ṭulayḥa would be killed if their people declared for Khālīd too soon — “and this is dearer to you than hastening them into the Fire.” After three days he came with **five hundred fighters**. He then did the same for Jadīla, bringing in a **thousand riders**. Ibn Kathīr: فَكَانَ عَدِيٌّ خَيْرَ مَوْلُودٍ وَأَعْظَمَهُ بَرَكََةً عَلَى قَوْمِهِ — “the best child ever born to his people and the greatest blessing upon them.”

al-Bidāya, vol. 7 p. 25

6. The three profiles — full detail

Abū Bakr al-Ṣiddīqؓ

- ‘Ā’ishaؓ: مَا أَسْلَمَ أَبُو أَحَدٍ مِنَ الْمُهَاجِرِينَ إِلَّا أَبُو بَكْرٍؓ — alone among the Muhājirūn, his father accepted Islam too.
- al-Zuhri describes him: fair, slight, with a lean frame — his izār would not stay on his hips.
- He traded to Buṣrā more than once, and spent his wealth on the Prophet ﷺ and in God’s path. The Prophet ﷺ: مَا نَفَعَنِي مَالٌ مَا نَفَعَنِي مَالُ أَبِي بَكْرٍؓ.
- ‘Urwa ibn al-Zubayr: he accepted Islam owning **forty thousand dinars**.
- ‘Amr ibn al-‘Āṣؓ asked the Prophet ﷺ which man he loved most. He said: “**Abū Bakr**.”

Siyar A‘lām al-Nubalā’, Rāshidūn p. 8

Khālīd ibn al-Walīdؓ

- Full lineage: Khālīd ibn al-Walīd ibn al-Mughīra ibn ‘Abd Allāh ibn ‘Umar ibn Makhzūm ibn Yaqaẓa ibn Ka‘b — Abū Sulaymān al-Qurashī al-Makhzūmī al-Makkī.
- Nephew of Umm al-Mu‘minīn **Maymūna bint al-Ḥārithؓ**.
- al-Dhahabī’s titles for him: sword of God, horseman of Islam, lion of the battlefields, the master, the imam, the great commander, leader of the fighters.
- **Migrated as a Muslim in Ṣafar, year 8**. Then went out to fight, and was at Mu‘ta.
- **Mu‘ta**: all three commanders the Prophet ﷺ had appointed were killed — Zaydؓ (his freedman), Ja‘farؓ (his cousin, *dhū al-janāḥayn*) and Ibn Rawāḥaؓ. The army stood with no commander. Khālīdؓ took command on the spot, took the banner, charged, **and the victory came**.
- The Prophet ﷺ then named him **Sayf Allāh**.

Siyar A‘lām al-Nubalā’, vol. 1 p. 366

Abū ‘Ubayda ibn al-Jarrāḥؓ

- ‘Āmir ibn ‘Abd Allāh. Meets the Prophet ﷺ in lineage at **Fihri**.
- The Prophet ﷺ testified he would be in Paradise, and **named him Amīn al-Umma**.
- Put forward at Saqīfa by Abū Bakrؓ himself — لِكُلِّ أَهْلِيَّتِهِ عِنْدَ أَبِي بَكْرٍؓ.
- Narrated few hadith — one in Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim, one in Jāmi‘ al-Tirmidhī, fifteen in Musnad Baqī — and fought many battles.

Siyar A‘lām al-Nubalā’, vol. 1 p. 6

7. Questions you may get — with sourced answers

“Wasn’t the pledge to Abū Bakrؓ rushed?”

See the boxed note on فَلْتَنَةً. Say what ‘Umarؓ said, both halves — that it was without prior arrangement, that God protected from its evil, and that there was no one like Abū Bakrؓ. His

purpose was to warn against repeating it, not to criticise it. Then stop.

“Why did ‘Alī[ؓ] not attend?”

al-Bidāya records that he and al-Zubayr[ؓ] and those with them were at Fāṭima’s[ؓ] house (vol. 5 p. 345). **Narrate that and stop.** Do not explain, do not infer, do not speculate about motive. If pressed: “session 3 handles this material with the fuqahā’s own rules.” The complete picture in this course is the one you gave in the Ridda block — ‘Alī[ؓ] leading Abū Bakr’s[ؓ] mount and begging him not to risk himself.

“Fighting people over zakāt — isn’t that harsh?”

Three sourced answers, in this order: (1) the commanders were ordered to **call first** and to **stop at the sound of the adhān** (vol. 7 p. 24); (2) Abū Bakr[ؓ] accepted the office **fearing fitna and apostasy**, and was proved right within weeks (vol. 5 p. 348); (3) the two chief rebels, ‘Uyayna and Ṭulayḥa, **both ended as Muslims**, one of them fighting alongside Khālīd[ؓ] (vol. 7 p. 26).

“Why does Khālīd[ؓ] get such prominence?”

Because Ibn Kathīr gives it to him — سَيِّدُ الْأُمَرَاءِ وَرَأْسُ الشُّجْعَانِ (vol. 7 p. 24) — and because the Prophet ﷺ named him Sayf Allāh. You are not making the judgment.

8. Still pending — do not improvise these

Jam‘ al-Qur‘ān. Not sourced here on purpose. It is doctrinally weighty and belongs to Rehan sahib’s Urdu treatment in the Abū Bakr[ؓ] chapter, not to Arabic pages selected by us. Until that arrives, keep the segment to the plain statement that the text was secured by procedure, and do not give details.

Yarmūk and Qādisiyya narrative detail. Cached at al-Bidāya vol. 7 pp. 85–95 and 132–140 but not yet worked through. The envoy’s exchange (vol. 7 p. 134) is verified and in the deck; everything else in those two blocks is currently outline only.

Dates. Every year in the script still carries [verify] until checked against *Tareekh-e-Ummat*.